



Examination By-Laws

Bachelor of Information Technology (General) Degree

Examination By-Laws

1. Introduction

These examination regulations provide the criteria and other conditions relating to examinations leading to the all degree programmes conducted by the Saegis Campus. Any interpretations of these regulations shall be submitted to the Academic Board and the decision of the Academic Board shall be final. These regulations shall be effective for the new entrants of the academic year 2016/2017 and thereafter.

2. Structure of the Degree Programme

The academic programmes of the Saegis Campus shall be full time degrees organized on a two-semester system, over a period of three academic years. Each academic year consists of two semesters, and each semester lasts for 15 weeks. Thus, the degree programmes shall constitute of 6 semesters, and examinations shall be held at the end of each semester.

3. Volume of Learning

The volume of learning at each level is described in terms of credits. Credit Hours are calculated according to SLQF guidelines. In the SLQF credit system, the student workload of a study programme is defined as 1500 notional learning hours per academic year.

The notional learning hours include direct contact hours with teachers and trainers, time spent in self-learning, preparation for assignments, carrying out assignments and assessments. The need to undertake any or all of these will be considered when a credit is being allocated to a course unit or a module, when the syllabus is designed. It is understood that the combination of learning activities may vary from one course unit or module to another.

One credit is considered equivalent to 50 notional learning hours for a taught course, laboratory studies course or field studies/clinical work. In case of industrial training, including time allocated for assessments and in case of research, including time allocated for literature survey, one credit is considered equivalent to a minimum of 100 notional hours.

Learning outcomes must be assessed by valid and reliable methods of assessment. Credits have to be earned by students after successful completion of the work required and appropriate assessment of learning outcomes.

4. Grading Scale

Student performance is graded on a 12- point scale, which ranges from E to A+. The grading scale is shown in Table 1.

Table 1: Grading Scale

Range of Marks	Grade	Grade Point
85 - 100	A+	4.00
70 - 84	A	4.00
65 - 69	A-	3.70
60 - 64	B+	3.30
55 - 59	B	3.00
50 - 54	B-	2.70
45 - 49	C+	2.30
40 - 44	C	2.00
35 - 39	C-	1.70
30 - 34	D+	1.30
25 - 29	D	1.00
0 – 24	E	0.00

End-Semester Examinations and Continuous Evaluation

5.1 Unless otherwise approved by the Academic Board, each course requires a final examination at the end of each semester. End-semester examination will be held during the final examination period. The duration of the examination can vary depending on the requirements for each course. Normally, they are of three-hour duration.

5.2 In addition, each course conducted by the Saegis Campus shall carry a continuous evaluation component. The method of continuous evaluation may include term papers,

case studies, presentations, practical reports, critical incidents, skill builders, class participation etc.

When a student has not completed continuous assessments during the year with valid reasons described in section 9, he/she may be allowed to participate in the continuous assessments held in the succeeding year. If it is not possible a special continuous assessment may be held for those students.

5.3 The overall grade for a course is based on the performance of all graded assessments for that course.

6. Eligibility Requirements to Sit for an End-Semester Examination

6.1 No student shall be permitted to sit for an examination unless the Head/Heads of the relevant Department/Departments has/have certified that he/she has completed the courses of study for the examination.

6.2 Students shall be admitted to the final examination only if they have complied with the attendance requirements and other regulations specified by this By law.

6.3 Failure to fulfil the attendance requirements disqualifies a candidate from sitting for that examination, but it is treated as an attempt. Such candidate/s shall repeat the course and shall be required to pay the additional examination fees as stipulated by the regulations.

6.4 Unless the Academic Board decides otherwise, a candidate shall present himself/herself for each examination on the first occasion on which the examination is held after the completion of the course of studies for the examination.

6.5 Students who fail to sit for an examination without authorization or without reason specified in this by-law shall be given a symbol of 'AB' (Absent) for that examination. This symbol is equivalent to a failing grade (E).

7. Guidelines for the Calculation of Final Marks for the Courses

- 7.1 The end-semester examination carries a weight not less than 50% except IT project. Any exceptions to the above shall be approved by the Academic Board. However candidate should earn at least 40% (out of 100%) from the end-semester examination.
- 7.2 The continuous evaluation component carries a weight of not more than **50%** of the final mark assigned to a course except IT project. This may comprise marks from one or more of the continuous evaluation modes such as mid-semester examinations/tests/quizzes, term and research papers, case studies, presentations, practical reports, skill builders.

When a candidate has not completed all the continuous assessments required for a course, the final marks shall be calculated based on the total marks allocated for the continuous assessments. For example, in a situation where 10 marks have been allocated for each of 4 continuous assessments scheduled, and the candidate has completed only 2 continuous assessments. If he/she scored 12 marks for those assessments the final marks for the continuous assessments will be 12/40.

- 7.3 If a course has mid-semester exam/practical test/quizzes etc. instead of continuous assessments, the mark obtained for the exam /test/quizzes etc. will be treated as the continuous assessment mark.

A student who gets absent for the mid semester exam /test/quizzes etc. with valid reasons given in Section 9 will be given the opportunity to do the exam /test/quizzes etc. or the continuous assessment in the succeeding academic year. If they get absent without valid reasons the student will be given a “00” (Zero) mark.

- 1.4 Students who re-sit for a course (Failed or absent without valid reasons) are not allowed to re-sit for the mid semester examination/test/quizzes etc. The final mark calculates using final examination mark with 100% weight but the maximum is 40%.
- 7.5 Students who re-sit for a course (Medical or absent with valid reasons) final mark calculates considering the carried forward continuous evaluation/ end semester marks. They can sit for the repeat exam with privileges.

- 7.6 When the course content is exclusively practical (e.g. Practical training), the evaluation shall be conducted according to guidelines prepared by the department of study and approved by the Academic Board.

8. Passing or Failing a Course

A candidate shall be deemed to have passed in a course if he/she obtains an overall average (weighted average marks of continuous evaluation and end-semester examination) of 40% or above for that course after satisfying the section 7.1 (candidate should earn at least 40% (out of 100%) from the end-semester examination).

- 8.1 If a candidate is absent for the end-semester examination or mid semester examination, the following symbol will be indicated appropriately.

8.11 Absent due to medical reason, which has been approved by the Academic Board, will be given the symbol of "MC" (Medical). Refer Section 9.2.

8.12 Absent due to valid reasons, which have been approved by the Academic Board, will be given the symbol of "DFR" (Deferred). Refer Section 9.3.

8.13 Absent without valid reasons will be given the symbol of "AB" (Absent).

9. Valid Reasons for Absence from an Examination

- 9.1 Excuse will be granted only if the absence is due to a grave cause such as the student's serious ill health, or death of some member of the immediate family or any other cause which is accepted by the Academic Board and approved by the Academic Board. If excuse is granted to a student, he/she can sit the examination on the next immediate occasion with privileges

- 9.2 A candidate who is absent at examinations due to medical reasons shall submit a medical certificate obtained from a Government Registered Medical Officer. This must be submitted to the Senior Assistant Registrar – Student Affairs of the Faculty within two weeks after holding the examination for the particular paper to be presented to the

Academic Board for approval. In that event, the student will receive a symbol of 'MC' for the course.

- 9.3 Absence of a candidate from an examination on account of bereavement in the family death of parent, brother or sister, and if married, spouse or child) will be excused if approval is obtained from the Academic Board by submission of the death certificate and appropriate proof of relationship. In that event, the student will receive a symbol of 'DFR' for that course.

10. Withdrawal for Medical Reasons

A student may withdraw from a course at any time during the semester on valid medical grounds with documentary proof. In that event, the student will receive a symbol of 'MC'. The student is required to follow the Faculty and Campus guidelines in requesting a medical withdrawal. A student has to sit for that course in the subsequent year unless written approval is obtained for an extended time period on the basis of the medical condition.

11. Repeating a Course

- 11.1 A student who obtains a grade of 'D' or 'E' shall repeat that course by registering in that course in a subsequent semester.
- 11.2 A student who obtains a grade of 'C-' or 'D+' may repeat that course by registering in that course in a subsequent semester.
- 11.3 A candidate who repeats course/s of an examination shall not be eligible to obtain more than 40% (minimum mark given for a 'C' grade) for each of the course/s, which he/she has repeated irrespective of the actual marks obtained. The maximum grade given for a repeated course is C.
- 11.4 If the student obtains a lower grade at a repeat attempt than a grade received in earlier attempts, the better grade shall be retained.

12. Repeating Continuous Evaluation of a Course

A candidate, who is absent with an acceptable reason in Section 9 at a mid-semester examination/test/quizzes etc. must be given another opportunity to undertake the said evaluation in the succeeding semester without any restriction of marks.

13. Repeating End-Semester Examination of a Course

13.1 No repeat examination will be conducted by the Saegis Campus for end semester examination. If a student fails an examination or was unable to sit for the examination due to ill health or any other valid reason in Section 9 he/she has the opportunity to sit for such examination when it is conducted during the next academic year.

13.2 A candidate who is absent from end-semester examination with a valid reason given in Section 9 above and which has been furnished by the candidate and accepted by the Academic Board, has to be treated as if he/she has not used the initial opportunity. Such candidate has to sit for the end-semester examination of that course by registering in that course during the next academic year with privileges. Such candidate has to sit that course in the subsequent academic year unless a written approval is obtained for an extended time period on the basis of the valid reason.

14. Absentees at End-Semester Examinations

A candidate who has been absent from a whole end-semester examination shall be treated as he/she has used an occasion, unless a valid reason has been furnished by the candidate and accepted by the Academic Board. A candidate with an accepted valid reason, eligible to take the whole end-semester examination on the next immediate occasion and get grading for courses without any restriction. If a candidate avoids taking the whole end-semester examination on the next immediate occasion without furnishing a valid reason, it shall be treated as a used attempt.

15. Guidelines for the Calculation of Grade Point Average

The Grade Point Average (GPA) is a numerical representation of a student's overall academic achievement. The GPA is the quotient obtained by dividing the total number of grade points earned by the total number of credit hours in which a student receives a 'letter' grade. Decimals beyond two places are truncated, not rounded, in computing the grade point average.

The formula for GPA calculation is given below

$$GPA = \frac{\text{Total Number of Grade Point Values Earned}}{\text{Total Number of Credit Hours}} = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^N (\text{Credit Hours})_i \times (\text{Grade Point})_i}{\sum_{i=1}^N (\text{Credit Hours})_i}$$

where, i = course number, and N = the total number of courses considered

The maximum possible GPA is 4.00 while the minimum is 0. Table 2 illustrates the calculation of the GPA of a hypothetical student at the end of the first semester of the degree programme.

Table 2: Illustration of GPA Calculation

Course Code	Grade Earned	Credit Hours	Grade Points	Number of Grade Point Values Earned = Credit Hours X Grade Point
	A+	3	4.00	12.00
	A -	3	3.70	11.10
	B -	3	2.70	8.10
	C+	3	2.30	6.90
	D	3	1.00	3.00
Total		15		41.10
$GPA = \frac{\text{Total Number of Grade Point Values Earned}}{\text{Total Number of Credit Hours}} = \frac{41.10}{15} = 2.74^*$ * Decimals beyond two places are truncated, not rounded, in computing the GPA.				

Table 3: Examination Results Sheet



Saegis Campus
School of Management and Finance
No : 135, Kohuwala, Nugegoda,
Sri Lanka.

<Name of Degree Programme>

Examination Result Sheet - < Year I/ II/ III>					
Full Name					
Student Registration Number					
Index Number					
Semester I / II (Month/Year)					
Course Code	Course Title	No. of Credits	Grade Obtained		
Grade Point Average : <PASS/ FAIL/MC >					
The above results are subject to confirmation by the Academic Board. Associate Dean School of Management & Finance Date					
Grading System					
Range of Marks	Grade	Grade Points	Range of Marks	Grade	Grade Points
85 – 100	A+	4.00	45 – 49	C+	2.30
70 – 84	A	4.00	40 – 44	C	2.00
65 – 69	A-	3.70	35 – 39	C-	1.70
60 – 64	B+	3.30	30 – 34	D+	1.30
55 – 59	B	3.00	25 – 29	D	1.00
50 – 54	B-	2.70	0 – 24	E	0.00
<i>Note: AB- Absent, MC - Medical, INC- Incomplete, DFR- Differed</i>					

16. Release of Examination Results

Results of the semester examinations will be published on the Saegis Campus Notice board. The GPA will be reported to the candidates at the end of each semester with the grade earned by the

candidate for each course as indicated in the grading scale given in Table 1. The results sheet will be issued to each candidate after the release of results of Semester of each year. A specimen of the results sheet is shown in Table 3.

17. Passing a Semester Examinations

A candidate shall be deemed to have passed any Semester Examinations of the degree programme, if he/she has earned a minimum GPA of not less than 2.00 for the semester with maximum of one weak pass (C- or below).

18. Passing Referred subjects in Semester Examinations

A candidate who has failed to fulfil the requirements given in Section 17 above shall sit for weak course/s (C- or below) and pass those courses under the relevant restrictions given in Section 11 above. Repeat subject/s result is limited to maximum of C grade.

19. Completion of Degree: Requirements for Graduation

In order to graduate with a bachelor's degree from the Saegis Campus, a student shall have:

- Completed the minimum number of semester hours prescribed for the relevant degree programme, and
- Earned a minimum GPA of not less than 2.00 for each semester and
- A minimum overall GPA of 2.00 for the entire degree programme, and
- Fulfilled all the requirements given above, within a maximum of 6 academic years from the academic year of original enrolment in the campus other than approved valid reason.

However, when a student reaches his/her last attempt of the degree programme the following procedure shall be applied in determining the result of that student.

- i. In calculating the GPA, the highest mark obtained by the student in any attempt shall be considered.
- ii. If it is a repeat attempt (without valied reason) he/she is able to obtain the maximum of C pass for the repeat subject/s.
- iii. The effective date of degree shall be the effective date relevant to the batch that was parallel to the student's last attempt.

20. Award of Classes

A student shall meet the following requirements in order to be awarded a degree with a Class Standing:

20.1 First Class Standing

- The student shall have earned an overall GPA of 3.70 or above in the entire degree programme.
- The student shall have earned grades of A or better in at least half the courses in the degree programme.
- The student shall not have earned grades below C.
- The student shall have fulfilled these requirements within six semesters from the first academic year of registration other than approved valid reason.

20.2 Second Class (Upper Division) Standing

- The student shall have earned an overall GPA of 3.30 or above in the entire degree programme.
- The student shall have earned grades of A-or better in at least half the courses in the degree programme.
- The student shall not have earned more than two poor grades (C- or D+) for entire degree programme.
- The student shall have fulfilled these requirements within six semesters from the first academic year of registration other than approved valid reason.

20.3 Second Class (Lower Division) Standing

- The student shall have earned an overall GPA of 3.00 or above in the entire degree programme.
- The student shall have earned grades of B+ or better in at least half the courses in the degree programme.
- The student shall not have earned more than two poor grades (C- or D+) for entire degree programme.

- The student shall have fulfilled these requirements within six semesters from the first academic year of registration other than approved valid reason.

21. Effective Date of the Degree

The effective date of the degree shall be the last date of the stipulated examination period on which the Year III Semester II Examination concludes. To be eligible for this effective date, a candidate shall submit the completed dissertation, if required by the respective degree, before the date specified by the relevant department.